

The Laws That Govern Meditation of His Word

Open to Psalm 1:1, and we are going to begin to study the laws of meditation, the laws that govern the meditation of His Word.

Psalm 1:1:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful. But his delight is in the law of the Lord; and in His law doth he meditate day and night. And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.

Good Lord, that should be enough incentive right there to get you meditating. Amen.

He says, "Blessed is the man." If there is anything on God's green earth that Dave Roberson wants to be, it is a blessed man of God. That is it. I do not care whether you put your seal on me, although I like you to like me. I do not care if your particular organizations or denominations in towns put their seal on me, although I like them to like me.

The only One I really care about putting His seal on me is my Father God.

When He said, "Blessed is the man," if there is anything on God's green earth I want to be, it is a blessed man of God.

What qualifies me to be this blessed man?

Number one, "Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly." Number two, "Nor standeth in the way of sinners." That is simply saying, blessed is the man who does not take his counsel from the world. Blessed is the man who does not do things the way sinners do.

I want to be that blessed man.

If I am not going to take my counsel from the world and I am not going to do things the way sinners do, then I had better take this one step further. The second verse says this man's delight is in the Word of God. His delight is in the Word of God, and in that Word he meditates day and night.

What is the purpose of meditation? What is meditation? I can tell you what it is not.

Meditation is not memorization, although memorization assists meditation. Meditation is not study, although study assists meditation. Meditation is not reading, although reading assists meditation.

What is meditation? Meditation is when I learn how to let the Holy Spirit get involved with my spirit in such a way that He takes the counsel that left the heart of God in the form of the Word and reconstructs it in my heart, in my spirit, so that it becomes the counsel I walk by. Then I do not have to do things the way the world does anymore.

That is the purpose of meditation.

The world has a lot of good counsel, but the world cannot guarantee you that everything you do will prosper. This man who meditates, He says, is like a tree planted by the water, and everything he does will prosper.

The fact that the world has some good counsel does not exclude the fact that there is a higher counsel. The higher counsel says I can find it through meditation. The higher counsel says:

 | Himself took our infirmities, and bare our sicknesses.

Glory to God, I do not have to have it. I do not have to have it.

That is the blessed man. That is the blessed man who meditates day and night to extract that kind of counsel out of the Word. If you are not going to meditate the Word of God, then you had better go to the world and get your counsel. They will give it to you.

Blessed is this man who meditates.

What is meditation? It is the involvement of the Holy Spirit in my spirit to extract the counsel I need so desperately to walk by, so I do not have to do things the way the world does anymore.

We are going to lay a very careful foundation. Very careful. If there is anything on God's green earth I want to be, it is that blessed man of God.

The man who taught me how to meditate was a man by the name of Earl Hitchens, and he taught me how to meditate quite by accident. He is the one who got me turned on to the Word.

I was an ultra, ultra, ultra holiness boy. And we were holy. If you did not believe it, look at our wives. There was not anything attractive about them. We were holy.

They would pour a bun on the back of their heads so tight that when they blinked, it jumped. They did not wear makeup, God forbid, or any jewelry or pants. It was horrible.

You should have heard the food we lived on.

"Get them devil stirrups off."

"Excuse me, sir, what is a devil stirrup?"

"An earring. That is what the devil uses to mount you women's minds with."

At least wear oval round ones like Earl's. They used to wind up from the floor.

If you were in a movie theater when the rapture took place, you would have plenty of time to finish your movie. If you were smoking a cigarette when the rapture took place, you would have plenty of time to finish your cigarette. They believed that with all their heart.

I was kind of hooked up in that. I thought you either had to choose a life of bland, tortured existence and go to heaven, or forget it, wondering all the time whether you were going to make it or not.

So here I was, existing as this young holiness boy, trying to learn how to preach. Earl Hitchens handed me a whole box full of Kenneth Hagin reel-to-reel, one-and-seven-eighths tapes, the days when Hagin would preach and teach three hours at a time. Big old long reels.

I started threading them up, and I remember the first time I heard Hagin. He sounded so boring. He sounded like somebody had been drinking cracker juice and tried to preach. He never raised his voice. He never dropped it. He stayed the same, monotone.

I was used to David Terrell and A. A. Allen. They would jump benches and chairs and scream. You could not go to sleep on them. They would run across your lap.

Here was Hagin:

"When I was a young Baptist boy on the bed of affliction, well, sir, God healed my body..."

I thought, "Sure, cracker juice. Sure."

I could not get but halfway through the tape. But I was full time, and after a couple of months went by and our cupboards got threadbare, I decided to get one of his tapes that said how to write your own ticket with God and hear it to the end. We were getting into quite a bit of trouble.

That was my first establishment and progression in the Word of God.

The man who gave me those tapes was named Earl Hitchens. You have to understand Earl. He was an old logger, and he just fit right into the landscape. I had never seen anybody look so natural in a plaid shirt, bright red suspenders, dungaree pants, cork boots with steel toes, and a chainsaw in his back pocket.

Earl, just a slow-talking logger, got me turned on to the Word.

Well, our church immediately went to, "Do not be moved by what you see, hear, or feel. Only by what you believe." Try to tell that to a bunch of fanatics who did nothing but emotionally scream and run around and brag when the guy did not get to preach.

"God really moved. He did not even get to preach."

You have heard that, have you not? Well, I found out if God was going to move, He had to do it before we preached. Afterwards, there was too much unbelief.

The church went down to nothing. There was only one pair left, and that was Earl Hitchens and about six or seven other adults. Earl was going broke.

One day Earl came to me and said, "Davey."

I said, "Yeah."

He said, "I want to teach the adult Sunday school class."

All six or seven of them.

Normally I prayed right up until time for the main service, then came out and ministered. So we were starting an adult Sunday school class, and Earl wanted to come in early and teach it.

I thought, "All right. He is a faith man. I think I am going to come in early and sit in and let him edify me before I teach and preach myself."

I could not wait to hear some Word.

So I went in and sat down, got comfortable, and opened my Bible in my lap. Earl got up, opened his Bible, took his text, and stood with it. I am waiting: Word, Word, Word, excitement. "Come on, Earl. Give us a good one."

Earl opened his Bible and said, "There was a certain rich man, and he fared..."

Then he watched a car go by.

"He fared sumptuously every day. He was accused that he had..."

After a while, he reached up and scratched.

"He said... how? How is this that I..."

I was sitting back in my seat, dying. Immediately I went into intercession.

I said, "Oh God, this is my prayer. Oh God, help me teach him how to teach, please."

God answered my prayer, only I did not know He was answering my prayer.

The logging industry shut down for the winter, and Earl came to me and said, "Dave."

I said, "Yeah."

He said, "I want to drive you to your meetings."

In those days, I was just beginning to have outside meetings.

I said, "All right, Earl. That would be neat. I can meditate all the way to the meeting."

Most of them were within fifty to eighty miles. I got excited.

So the first day he picked me up, I crouched over in the corner. You have to understand Earl. When Earl got real excited about one of his payoffs, his foot would go through the carburetor. One time we came up on a Greyhound bus being passed by a truck, and we passed both of them on a

two-lane highway. Both of them. Then when he got to a boring part, his foot would fall off and we would be doing thirty-five. Cars would be honking and backed up for five miles.

So I was crouched over against the door. I opened my Bible and started meditating. All of a sudden, I hear this:

"Davey. How are you doing, Davey boy? Did I ever tell you the story about the time my old man picked a hog and had me crate her up and bring her to the neighbors?"

I wanted to meditate. I was thinking to myself, "No, you did not, but you are about to, are you not, Earl?"

Sure enough, he did. It did not do any good to try to meditate.

He said, "Davey, I got our best roping horse."

I was trying to ignore him.

He said, "I got our best roping horse and went out and roped this old sow, biggest sow you ever saw, six or seven hundred pounds. Big thing."

I said, "Yeah."

He said, "That horse was our best cattle horse. In those days we grazed our hogs. I roped her and was dragging her toward the crate. All of a sudden, the rope went dead. Me and the horse turned around just in time to see that hog square off with us. All of a sudden she charged like a rhinoceros. It sounded like a freight train coming down on us, huffing and puffing and squealing and swinging her head side to side."

By this time my Bible had closed.

He said, "That horse knew exactly what to do. She reared up on her hind legs and struck that hog right between the eyes. That hog staggered off stunned with blood running down her face, squealing and screaming. Then she spun around, lined up on the horse, and came again. The horse did exactly the same thing. Three times."

"The fourth time, that hog mauled that horse. It got it on some kind of ram in the hindquarters and knocked it flat on its side."

Earl said, "Boy, while that hog was mauling that horse, I got the end of the rope. There were three fence posts standing alone in the pasture. I ran as fast as I could. I did not just tie the end of the rope to one of them; man, I tied it to three of them."

"I turned around just in time to see the horse get up and make a run for it. That hog was spinning around, blood running down her face. All of a sudden she saw me standing there and lined up on me."

Earl said, "I did not wait around, man. I took off running. I beat her to the end of the rope, and it snapped like a toothpick. I beat her to the end of the second post, and it snapped like a toothpick. When I turned around to see where she was, I tripped, landed on my back, and I was scooching as fast as I could to get under the fence. She came up on me like a steam engine, opened her mouth that wide, her breath blasted my hair back, and she stuck my whole face in her mouth."

By this time, my spirit was gone. I was sitting on the edge of the car seat. My hair was standing on end. I had goosebumps up and down my spine.

"My God, Earl, get on with it."

He said, "By the way, the last post held out."

Earl had turned me inside out. He had me on the edge of my seat the whole time. I had never heard anything like it.

All of a sudden, this little voice spoke up on the inside of me. I thought it was me, because the Holy Spirit had to trick me in those days. See what God was doing? He was answering my prayer.

"Which one?"

"Oh God, please help me teach him to teach."

This little voice spoke up on the inside of me, and He used my language, my dialogue. It said, "Reckon why he cannot teach like that?"

I thought, "Yeah, my God, if Earl could teach like that in the class, everybody would be on the edge of their chairs. Their eyes would be extended and protruding slightly. Their hair would be sticking straight up on end. We would all fall off our chairs, not even knowing we were leaning forward. I wonder why Earl cannot teach like that."

I thought I thought of it, but the Spirit said that so He could answer it.

The Spirit said, "The reason Earl cannot teach like that is because when he stands up to teach, he is simply mentally assenting to documented facts that he knows to be so, recorded some two thousand years ago. It has not become part of him. He has not become part of the Word. Therefore, he is mentally relating to you facts, figures, or anything else that happened two thousand years ago."

He said, "The reason there was so much life in his hog story is because it happened to him. When it happened to him, it became part of him, and he became part of the story. So when he was speaking that story, it was reality. It was truth. His words were full of the very essence of truth."

Then the Spirit said something to me that changed my life, something I shall never forget as long as I live.

He said, "Son, there is a place in My Spirit. There is a place of meditation in Me that I can actually take you to. You can meditate until the Word actually becomes part of you, and you actually become part of the Word."

There is a place in Him and in His Spirit where you are not mentally assenting to documented facts that happened two thousand years ago. There is a place in the Spirit where this Word actually becomes reality. It becomes part of you, and you become part of it.

It is no longer, "Himself has borne my sicknesses and carried my pains." It is reality. My God, man, He actually bore my sickness. He actually carried my pain.

There is a place in Him where the Word becomes part of you and you become part of it. But it is a place in meditation.

Now let us take this just a little bit further.

Several times now, God has brought me to where I will meditate the Word of God so long that I get lost in it. The Holy Spirit actually begins to paint a picture within my spirit. Each verse is a stroke of the brush. It comes alive with reality until I can see it. It is almost like I am standing there looking at it, like He is transporting me into it.

It is reality. It is happening to me. It is no longer something I am mentally assenting to. It literally comes alive.

I remember some of the first truths He brought. One of them was, "Surely He hath borne our sicknesses and carried our pains."

Let me show you briefly what I am talking about before we go into this next principle.

How many of you know, as a documented fact and a spiritual right that you and I possess, that surely He has borne our sicknesses and carried our pains? Has He not? Do we not all know that?

I kept meditating that one day. I meditated it hour after hour. I prayed in the Holy Ghost and pored over those verses again and again. I got my Greek interlinear, outerlinear, exterior, interior, Wuest, and Strong's out. I meditated until my meditator felt like it fell out on the ground.

I broke the Word:

| Surely He hath borne our sicknesses, and carried our pains.

The word sicknesses in the Hebrew was actually *cho1i*, and it is actually interpreted sicknesses instead of griefs. Sorrows was actually interpreted pains some twelve other times in the Old Testament Hebrew. So Isaiah 53:4 really says:

| Surely He hath borne our sicknesses, and carried our pains.

When He became every damnable thing we were, that was imagery created within my spirit through that kind of meditation. He actually took me back there. It had a supernatural flavor. I saw the whole thing, and it is reality in me now. You cannot take it. It fills my words with power. You cannot have it.

I kept looking at, "Surely He has borne my sicknesses and carried my pains." The word borne had the insinuation that a load of sicknesses and pains was laid on Him, like you lay a load of sticks on a burro. Actually laid on Him. Surely He has borne the weight of my sicknesses and pains.

The insinuation was that not only were they laid on Him as a burden and a weight, but He transported them from point A to point B.

My question to God was, "Where did He carry them? What did He do with them?"

You and I know He carried them to the cross and died under the penalty of them. Everything began to open up. Even as the strong man dragged the scapegoat into the wilderness to be destroyed by wild beasts, Jesus was borne down into hell by the strong man to be destroyed. He was my scapegoat.

I said, "You mean He went to the cross to die under the penalty of my sicknesses and pains?"

I kept meditating and thinking on it. If He died under the penalty of my sicknesses and pains, then it would be a miscarriage of justice for me to die of a sickness or pain when the only qualified Redeemer to carry my sickness and pain died of it.

It would be a miscarriage of justice if God asked me to carry sicknesses and pains to teach me something, when the only qualified Redeemer is Christ Jesus Himself. If I was qualified, I would have carried my own sin. But I am no more qualified to carry my own sin than I am my sickness and disease, and I am no more qualified to carry my own poverty.

Glory to God.

I kept meditating on this. I knew as a fact that He bore my sicknesses and pains. But it is a pretty big step sometimes to get the facts into the spirit where they produce power.

All of you are sitting around knowing that:

"He bore my sicknesses and carried my pains."

How is your body doing?

"Not too good."

So I kept meditating on it. How many know the Word of God says:

I am crucified with Christ: nevertheless I live.

He was the only perfect Substitute. He was the only One qualified to go to the cross, die, and resurrect in my place. Yet in the eyes of God, as my perfect Substitute, I was crucified with Him. God saw you on the cross. That is what a perfect Substitute is.

It finally dawned on my lightning-quick mind that if I was crucified with Him, then when Jesus died under the penalty of my sicknesses and pains, I died with Him.

Do you know what that means? It means Jesus already died under the penalty of cancer, MS, sugar diabetes, blindness, and every other damnable disease Satan could ever create in his workshop. He already died under the penalty, but I died with Him.

That means I have already died of cancer once. I have already died of heart trouble once. I have already died of sugar diabetes once, when I died with Him.

There is no court in the land that will try you twice for the same crime. If you are tried and freed, then, buddy, you are free. When Satan laid all that disease on Jesus, you died with Him. That means you already died of every damnable disease he could ever invent once, and he does not have the power to try and crucify you again.

Well, that kind of got me excited.

But that was just the tip. Meditation began to get deeper, and the Word became more and more part of me, and I became more and more part of it.

Now, on this last step, because I have been feeling things begin to change, if there was anyone I wanted to pattern my teaching after, guess who it would be? It would be Jesus. I want to pattern my teachings after Jesus.

Let me give you one more step of meditation. There is one thing I have found out about Jesus' teachings: when Jesus taught, He always taught in total and entire subjects.

If Jesus was teaching from that pulpit, using the mastery and imagery of words, He would begin at the top. By the time He reached the bottom, He would have painted a perfect picture in your spirit using the mastery and imagery of words.

Every verse, every Scripture within the subject matter, within the picture, within the image, is a thought within itself. It is a stroke of the brush. But invariably it is always building toward the completion of the entire picture.

Would it not be stupid to have an ocean scene, a complete ocean scene, nothing but water and clouds, and then have an army tank coming over the horizon? Or to have an apple tree with an orange growing on it?

That is what we have done.

I want to show you just briefly, because He is starting to change the anointing now, but I wanted to give enough facts to set you. Tomorrow night we are going to begin to break some of the most difficult verses in the Word of God, some of the most difficult things to understand.

We are going to be studying more the method of breaking these verses and extracting the counsel than the content itself. We are going to study the method of getting the counsel even more than the counsel we are getting.

If I can somehow give you the tree, then every year at due season you get your own crop. But if all I do is come here and give you a crop, then after the crop is gone, everything else is too.

Which would you rather have, the tree?

Of course you would.

Jesus, being the Master Teacher, the best who ever lived and the best who ever existed, taught in total and entire subjects. When I found that out, I made the job of the Holy Spirit in my life so much easier.

You say, "How?"

I used to pull a singular verse out of context and meditate on it. What I was asking God for was the exception and not the rule. The exception is that the Holy Spirit can do it. He can take that verse and paint the entire picture around it. He can do it. But it is the exception and not the rule.

The rule is that you need to meditate the whole picture until an outline is formed within your spirit. When that outline is formed, then the verses that are difficult, the last ones to come together, eventually the Holy Spirit will be able to stroke the brush and complete the picture, thus producing the faith.

If I paint the trunk of the tree, it stands to reason that it is easier to direct my thinking to know that a limb is coming next. When I paint a limb, and then the twigs and branches on the limb, I can stand to reason that the leaves are coming next.

But if somebody picks a leaf out and you do not know what a leaf is, then it is quite a job for the Holy Spirit to put a tree on that leaf.

Understand. It is like the bum who asked a woman--she lived by the railroad track--he beat on her door and handed her a button and said, "Ma'am, would you sew a shirt on this?"

There is a place of meditation. In these services to come, we are going to study the method: the method of the Spirit's involvement in your spirit to extract that kind of counsel. How He does it, how to listen for it, and how to know that it is Him.

If you give us time, we can teach you all those things.